

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

As normal, Greg was ready the first few days, but then lapsed into sleeping late. The supervisor told Greg's grandmother, "You put a full pitcher of water in the refrigerator every night. I'll get him up."

The next day when he came, Greg was still asleep. He took the pitcher of (very) cold water and went into Greg's room. He said, "Greg, you going to work today?" "Yes, sir," Greg replied, "in a minute," and he went back to sleep. His sleep was interrupted by two quarts of near-freezing water.

He fussed and fumed while he was getting dried off and dressed for work. His grandmother cackled, "I'll leave that mess for you to clean up tonight!"

The next day the whole routine repeated itself. The third day when the supervisor came to get Greg, he asked his grandmother if he was still in bed. She said, "Well, he got up but I believe he's asleep again." When she opened the refrigerator door to get the pitcher, Greg heard it and leapt out of bed, fully clothed!

As time passed, Greg became one of the most valued employees this company had. He is now a plant manager with children of his own. You can be certain that he is teaching his children to do their work well, on time, and with dependability. Greg often says to his sons, "If a stranger loved me enough to hold me accountable for my work habits, I sure can do as much for you boys."

Remember that the earlier you start instilling the right habits in your children, the easier it is. It's *never* too late, but the earlier the better. "Correct your son, and he will give you comfort; he will also delight your soul" (Proverbs 29:17).

(3) *Reward extra effort.* If your children are excellent at what they do and put forth extra effort, they should be rewarded for doing a superior job.

Paul said, "The hard-working farmer ought to be the first to receive his share of the crops" (2 Timothy 2:6). It's important that your children understand the "no-work, no-pay" principle. But it is just as important that they understand the "better-work, better-pay" principle.